

Week 3: Natural Resources

JSS3 Intermediate Science — First Term Lesson Note (Deep-Dive Edition)

Introduction

This week examines natural resources — materials provided by nature that humans use — and how they must be managed responsibly to remain available for future generations.

Types of Natural Resources

Type	Description	Examples
Renewable resources	Resources that can be replenished naturally within a human lifetime, if managed well	Sunlight, wind, water, forests, fish
Non-renewable resources	Resources that take millions of years to form and cannot be quickly replaced	Crude oil, natural gas, coal, minerals

Importance to the National Economy

Natural resources are central to Nigeria's economy: crude oil and natural gas remain major sources of national revenue and foreign exchange; agricultural land supports farming and food production; and mineral deposits (such as tin, coal, and limestone) support mining and manufacturing industries.

Conservation and Management

- **Sustainable use** – using resources at a rate that allows them to be replenished
- **Afforestation and reforestation** – planting trees to replace forests that have been cut down
- **Regulation** – government policies controlling extraction rates (e.g., fishing quotas, mining licenses)
- **Recycling and efficient use** – reducing waste of resources such as water and energy

Field Observation Project

As a practical activity, identify a natural resource used in your local community (e.g., a river, forest, or farmland). Observe and record how it is used, whether it shows signs of overuse or depletion, and suggest one way it could be better managed. Present your findings to the class.

Real-Life Application

A community relying on a local river for fishing must manage it sustainably — overfishing could exhaust fish stocks, while responsible fishing practices (such as controlled catch sizes) allow the resource to replenish and support the community for years to come.

Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
Renewable	Able to be naturally replenished over time
Non-renewable	Existing in a limited supply that cannot be quickly replaced

Conservation	The careful protection and management of resources
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Evaluation Questions

- 1 Define natural resources.
- 2 Distinguish between renewable and non-renewable resources, with two examples of each.
- 3 Name two natural resources important to Nigeria's economy.
- 4 Explain what "sustainable use" of a resource means.
- 5 What is afforestation, and why is it useful for conservation?
- 6 Give one example of a government regulation that helps manage natural resources.
- 7 Why are non-renewable resources considered more at risk of running out?
- 8 Describe the purpose of the field observation project this week.
- 9 Give a real-life example of a natural resource in your community and how it is used.
- 10 In your own words, explain why conservation of natural resources matters for future generations.